

ospective

An important task is to create a retrospective thread within the Becoming a GitLab Manager issue, so that the team member can log any questions, comments, proposals and more about their issue. Retrospectives are used in many ways at GitLab, like after a GitLab product release based on the Product retrospective workflow. For the Becoming a GitLab Manager issue, simply comment in the issue, starting a thread titled Retro thread or Retrospective. Feel free to please ask any questions in the managers Slack channel.

Coaching remote work practices

Do not assume that team members understand good remote work practices. GitLab managers are expected to coach their reports to utilize asynchronous communication, be handbook-first, design an optimal workspace, and understand the importance of self-learning and self-service.

Leaders should ensure that new remote hires read a getting started guide, and make themselves available to answer questions throughout one's journey with the company.

Create a personalized learning pathway

Take a moment to reflect on where you are in this transition. Then use this google form to add your thoughts about the challenges you face, how you plan to overcome them, and what resources you have found helpful so far. The Learning and Development team will review this feedback to personalize your development pathway as a manager at GitLab. This may include developing custom training modules, pairing you with a mentor, or providing you with opportunities to practice skills.

Participate in the Elevate program

Elevate equips new and existing managers with a set of skills to managing all-remote teams. The program covers foundational management practices. One of the key benefits of the program is networking and social learning. You will learn from other managers and build a sense of community across people leaders at GitLab.

Transitioning to a Manager Video

{{< youtube "g7ZnhQYsrIU" >}}

Content Sources:

- How to Manage Your Former Peers, Harvard Business Review
- Coping successfully with your transition, Lynda.com
- Are You A First-Time Manager? Here Are 5 Essential Tips for Success!, Inc.com
- Use This Tactic To Avoid Burnout As A New Manager, American Management Association

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/manager-development/high-performing-teams.md

Part of a people leader's responsibilities is to build a high performing team. There are many

things which go into enabling this to occur, including leaders being a guide to help their team members understand how to use the tools available to achieve their ambitions.

Talent Assessments

How to set yourself up for promotions

{{< youtube id="U28nKJpMRPQ" title="Trust and the Talent Assessment process" >}}

1. Getting feedback during the talent assessment process can produce anxiety in some people. Being mindful of how you process feedback and constructive criticism and proactively communicating about how you intend to deliver feedback and how you would like to receive feedback can help minimize the anxiety for you and others. This transcript of an interview can help bring a new perspective for how to contextualize feedback.

1. There is a tendency in the talent assessment process to focus on how to eliminate your areas of opportunity and continue to build on your strengths; while that is certainly a great focus it can also be helpful to think about the limits of that model. This podcast episode talks about the inflection point when strengths can start to become liabilities. This might help lend some perspective as you go into your talent assessment process.

1. This article can help focus how you're thinking about a talent assessment and what you can do proactively to prepare. This article should help you to feel like you have control over the outcome of your talent assessment (which you do).

1. This video talks about a new way of thinking about how to measure success. This can help you bring a fresh perspective to the talent assessment process and might help you advocate for yourself in the areas of your success that might not be traditionally measured.

1. This article provides 4 straight forward concepts to assist in doing your self assessment: (1) separate yourself from your work (2) don't shy away from self-critique (3) focus on the outcomes of your actions, and (4) ask and adjust.

1. This article provides 10 useful tips to prepare for, and succeed in, your annual review from a performance perspective. What were your goals (personal, departmental, etc.), how did you contribute, and what were the results?

1. Performance v. Trust

- Of course, performance (and results) are fundamental to a talent assessment, but trust is an often overlooked trait that should be cultivated to reach your maximum potential. At the end of the day, high trust leads to better growth.

Using career ladders

1. GitLab has established a standardized set of expectations for folks in each level via the Job Framework. Some departments like Engineering have articulated career frameworks which enumerate functional competencies expected of those within those departments. The key thing to know about these tools is they enumerate expected behaviors of folks in the roles, and it can be helpful to see how other companies articulate these ideas. Progression.fyi is a helpful site for understanding these tools as it provides a collection of career ladders published by various organizations.

1. Titles don't mean the same thing at every company. The same is true about leveling and career progression · companies think about this topic differently. Frankly, some don't take it seriously at all. Whatever our experiences have taught us, frequently we need to relearn what

it means when we join a new organization. This blog entry helps us understand how to approach this topic with objectivity as we seek to understand the processes which exist within the company.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/mentor/_index.md

Mentorship is an opportunity to learn from personal experience, background, and perspective. Mentorship builds trust, provides a safe space to make mistakes, and encourages growth for both the mentor and mentee. Reach out in the mentoring Slack channel with questions or feedback.

The Power of Mentoring

{{< youtube "0W3d-PJ4-FM" >}}

How to get started

Team members have multiple options to participate in mentorship at GitLab.

1. Identify and self-select a mentor from your professional network or the list of available mentors below.
1. Make yourself available as a mentor by following these steps.
1. Participate in an organized mentorship program where mentors and mentees are paired based on an application process.

What team members are Saying

1. Although not directly, but my mentor has indirectly helped me with my OKRs. My mentor has given me more confidence and knows-how in approaching my OKR goals.
1. With advice from my mentor, I was able to adjust the way I was reporting on my OKRs & projects to better communicate my progress. I also was coached on how to prepare myself for feedback & criticisms on my projects and how to better receive those comments - not taking them personally, and striving to be a part of the solution to fixing problems versus thinking I am the problem.
1. I have learnt to navigate GitLab code and improve my debugging skills, which directly feeds into delivering exceptional experience to my efficiency, customers results and skills development.
1. My mentor has been a force in my life. She is incredible - from helping me navigate new manager styles to how to prospect to how to deal with my mental health better - she's so so good. I hit the jackpot! I am in such a better place to actually work hard with her on my team, so the impact is indirectly directly related to my ability to sell.

Results

In FY23 Q1, 17% of mentees in current organized mentorship programs completed a survey and reported the effects of the mentorship on business and personal results.

<iframe

src="https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/e/2PACX-1vSQo5yL0DOCgaAQWwXaIYHfb20pG1xlkzxBBxgI

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Benefits and Expectations

Benefits for the mentee

1. Be encouraged to prioritize, and be held accountable for, your career development
1. Learn new skills related to your current role, your future career goals, or an area that you're passionate about
1. Set and reach clearly outlined goals.

Benefits for the mentor

1. Serve as a leader in the organization by enabling growth for other team members
1. Practice leadership, effective communication, and coaching skills
1. Establish yourself as an expert in a field or speciality
1. Build trust with team members

Expectations

| Expectation | Description |

| ----- | ----- |

| Mentees lead conversations | Mentorship is led by the mentee, similar to how 1:1's at GitLab are driven by direct reports. |

| Maintain Boundaries | Maintain clear and appropriate boundaries. Be clear on your responsibilities and those of their manager. |

| Set Goals | Mentees should create goals, put them in writing, and frequently revisit goals to measure progress. |

| Build Trust | Colleague first, expert second. Spend time getting to know one another. Be open, honest, and fully authentic. |

| Set Expectations | Be realistic and uphold your commitment. Share access to resources and people, but make it clear you do not wield your influence over others. |

| Listen | Establish trust and openness in communication. Give your full, undivided attention. Hear concerns before offering advice and guidance. |

| Acknowledge Independence | Recognize mentee goals and autonomy. Your role as a mentor is to guide; it's up to the mentee to decide what to implement in their own career. |

| Respect Diverse Experiences | Recognise that underrepresented groups might face additional barriers to advancement. Educate yourself and ask for advice and support via the appropriate DIB channels. |

| Practice Self-Awareness | Identify your strengths, weaknesses, and biases. Be aware of and respect other's experiences, ideas, and goals. |

| Advocate | Mentor others on being effective managers or colleagues to those who might have different experiences to them. Teach your mentee how to become a mentor themselves · by example and by encouragement. |

| Express Gratitude | Share openly about your experience. Express gratitude for the skills or experiences developed over time. |

| Maintain a Growth Mindset | Practice a growth mindset. Both parties can learn and grow from mentorship |

| Iterate | Iterate on goals throughout the mentorship. Focus on quick wins that the mentee can reach, then keep growing. |
| Confidentiality | Respect the trust built between mentor and mentee. Challenges and conversations shared in mentorship sessions should be kept confidential unless the mentor and mentee are okay with them being shared. |

Adapted from the NCWIT Mentoring-in-a-Box Mentoring Basics - A Mentor's Guide to Success, section What Are the "Dos" of Mentoring and People Grove resources

Find a mentor

The following team members are available as mentors. Schedule a coffee chat to get the conversation started!

The Expertise column comes from the team member .yaml entry and might not include all subjects they can help you with.

```
{{< group-by-expertise "mentor" >}}
```

Become a mentor

1. Indicate your mentorship availability on the GitLab team page by setting the mentor status to true. This will appear on the team page with a line that reads Available as a mentor.

Example MR

Organized mentorship programs

Learn more about organized mentorship programs for team members:

- 1. Company-Wide
- 1. Minorities in Tech
- 1. Women at GitLab
- 1. Aspiring Managers
- 1. Finance Team is running a mentorship program.

Resources

Resources below are designed to guide mentor/mentee relationships in both synchronous and asynchronous formats. Adopt what fits and leave what doesn't.

Mentor and Mentee training

Enjoy the following Google Slides presentation on finding a mentor, setting clear expectations, and achieving goals through mentorship.

```
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width="960" height="569" allowfullscreen="true" mozallowfullscreen="true"  
webkitallowfullscreen="true"></iframe>
```

Mentee: What to do before your mentorship begins

1. Set up a coffee chat with your mentor. Take time to get to know them and build trust.

Discuss communication styles and preferences.

1. Set a specific goal for your mentorship. It's OK if you don't reach 100% of your goal during the mentorship.

1. Join the mentoring Slack channel

Mentee: Set your goal and purpose

In their book *Burnout: the secret to unlocking the stress cycle*, authors Emily and Amelia Nagoski explain the difference between goals and purpose:

| Idea | Definition |

| ---- | ----- |

| Goal | the what - outcome driven |

| Purpose | the why - value driven |

Mentees should set a foundational goal and purpose for their mentorship. Mentee goals should drive the relationship.. Mentors might also set a goal around their own growth objectives as a mentor. Both mentors and mentees bring their own original purpose to mentorship.

What is your goal?

| Criteria | Description |

| ----- | ----- |

| Time-bound | When will the goal be complete? |

| Certain | Is achievement of the goal within your control? |

| Specific | What is the desired outcome? |

| Positive | What positive impact will the outcome create? |

| Measurable | How will success be measured? |

| Personal | Why does achieving the goal matter? Tie goal to purpose. |

Using the matrix below, fill in each empty space based on the descriptions above to draft your goal:

| Time-bound | Certain | Specific | Positive | Measurable | Personal |

| ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- |

| | | | | |

This structure is adapted from *Burnout: the secret to unlocking the stress cycle* and the SMART goal framework. Learn more about goal setting by taking the *Setting Team and Employee Goals using SMART Methodology* LinkedIn Learning course

Setting tool-specific goals

Goals that are specific to learning a tool, like increasing confidence with GitLab, might be challenging to fit in the SMART model. Consider asking yourself these two questions to help clarify your goal.

1. What will you do to improve your understanding of the GitLab product?
1. How will you show that you have improved your understanding of the GitLab product / what do you expect to be able to do?

Then, try breaking down your goal into clear actions as shown in the examples below:

- > Example 1: Improve my understanding of GitLab product by X date
- >
- > 1. Move all personal projects to GitLab
- > 1. Configure CI/CD tools to automate 1 manual task
- > 1. Track career development in a personal project
- >
- > Example 2: Learn about Ruby by X date
- >
- > 1. Take X course
- > 1. Resolve 3 ruby bugs in the product
- > 1. Create 1 blog post with learnings

What is your purpose?

Purpose is value-driven and based on your values. Determine what values drive you to be part of a mentorship and complete the following statement:

I'm a mentor/mentee because I care about value. Value drives me to be a mentor/mentee because your why.

Communicate your goal and purpose

Discussions about goals and purpose should be part of your first mentorship meeting. Progress and iterations on goals should be revisited often.

Mentee: Set a Meeting Schedule

Set clear expectations with your mentor/mentee about when, how often, and for how long you will formally meet. Below is a suggested format for this meeting cadence:

1. Establish a timeframe: 3-6 month is suggested
1. Set a meeting cadence every other week for 30-45 minutes or agree to spend 30-45 minutes every other week communicating asynchronously

Sample sync meeting agendas

Mentorship agendas are important for resources documentation and future planning. The mentee should be the DRI for each session and use the agenda to set meeting goals and ask questions. Use and customize the following meeting agenda templates as a baseline for each session. Please make a copy of these templates and save to your own Google Drive.

1. Initial Meeting Agenda Template
1. Regular Meeting Agenda Template
1. Final Meeting Agenda Template

Sample agendas below are inspired by resources from Arizona State University and People Grove.

Sample async meeting formats

GitLab issues can be used to collaborate async in a mentorship. Use this issue template to get started.

Other tools for async mentorship

1. Template for using Google Docs

1. Slack voice memos

1. Slack recording

1. Loom recording

Track your progress

Use this issue template to track progress on goals set for both mentor and mentee.

Ending your mentorship

Mentorships end or change over time. Review these guidelines for how to end your mentorship with grace and some suggested actions to take as your mentorship ends.

1. It's OK for a mentorship to end if the mentor and mentor and mentee feel they've accomplished a goal or if the pair isn't a good fit. Consider having a coffee chat with your mentor/mentee to discuss what was accomplished or what didn't work. Thank each other for dedicating time for the mentorship.

1. Mentorship doesn't have to end, either! Establish a meeting cadence to stay connected with your mentor. You might meet 1x per month for a coffee chat, connect async via Slack, or continue with your 2x monthly sessions.

1. Share your mentorship results with your manager or your direct reports. Take time in your 1:1s to share why and how the mentorship helped you reach your goals, either professionally or personally. This is also a great time to connect your mentorship with the accomplishment of your OKRs, if it helped you achieve results.

1. Add your mentorship to your resume or to your LinkedIn profile. For mentors, this might look like a separate entry to demonstrate leadership. For mentees, you might mention the mentorship in relation to the goals you achieved.

1. Write a blog or LinkedIn post with a shout out to your mentor/mentee, highlighting what you learned and what surprised you.

Additional Resources

These resources are meant to provide both mentors and mentees with additional personal and professional development. Consider reviewing these resources asynchronously and discuss/debrief them during a session with your mentor/mentee.

Why the Power of Mentoring can Change the World

{{< youtube "u4kTIK5mUHc" >}}

1. The Engineering department outlines strategies for mentors and mentees with suggestions on how to host meetings and set and evaluate goals.
1. The Support team has outlined expectations and examples on Mentorship in Support Engineering.
1. Career growth resources at GitLab
1. Harvard Business Review: What efficient mentorship looks like
1. Harvard Business Review: What great mentorship looks like in a hybrid workplace
1. Harvard Business Review: The best mentorship help both people grow

FAQs for New Mentors and Mentees

Is this your first mentorship at GitLab? Maybe it's your first time as a mentor. Check out the FAQ section below as a guide to find resources you need to make your mentorship a success.

| Question | Answer |

| ---- | ---- |

| Where do I find resources about being a great mentor or mentee? | On this page! The expectations table is the best place to start. |

| Are there meeting templates I can use? | Yes! We have meeting templates for the initial session, ongoing sessions, and final mentorship sessions here. Mentors should encourage their mentees to start these and populate before each session. |

| How do I connect with and learn from others in GitLab's mentorship programs? | Each organized mentorship program has a Slack channel. The program organizers will post resources and discussion prompts there throughout the length of the program. Use these channels to ask questions and gain experience from other mentors and mentees. |

| How do I get feedback from my mentor or mentee? | Asking for feedback at the end of the program is a great time to connect and reflect on your relationship. You might also request feedback from your mentor or mentee during our 360 review cycle. |

| Who drives the mentorship meetings? | Mentees will drive the meetings. Mentees should come prepared to each session with questions or topics to discuss related to their mentorship goal. |

|

| Is there a mentorship confidentiality agreement? | While there is no formal agreement, confidentiality is one of the key expectations of mentors and mentees at GitLab. You can review this and other expectations in the table above |

How to organize an all-remote mentorship program

Consider the following practices and lessons learned by the GitLab team when organizing your own all-remote mentorship program. Open a Merge Request to contribute your own learning to list!

1. Share call for applications across multiple channels and do direct outreach to great mentors for the best engagement. Lean on People Business Partners for suggestions of team members who would make great mentors and mentees.
1. In applications, ask for role, location, and mentorship focus area, along with ideal goals. Use multiple choice questions to easily sort and pair responses.
1. Give at least 2 weeks for folks to apply as mentors and mentees. Keep applications open past the deadline for rolling applications with a note that late applicants might not be paired. Rolling applications might help fill in the gaps with hard to pair mentors/mentees
1. Collaborate with Team Member Relations and People Business Partners to ensure that

participants are not on performance improvement plans and that their work performance qualifies them to participate (as program applications outline)

1. Consider using automation, if available, to pair. At GitLab we haven't used automation yet, but we are exploring it for future iterations.

1. If pairing manually, set aside at least 1 week to work on making pairs based on application responses. Consider recruiting a committee to delegate to.

1. Use Slack to send a message to mentors and mentees once paired. Put all relevant information for starting the program into one message and consider using both text and a short video to share this information.

1. Use a dedicated mentorship Slack channel to communicate to participants over the length of the program.

1. Send 1-2 resources via Slack throughout the program to keep participants engaged and learning.

1. Use Polly or another survey tool to do a 1 month check in with mentees. This helps identify pairs that have not yet met or folks that might have left the company.

1. Give participants at least 3 weeks to complete the end of program survey.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/mentor/company-program.md

Fill out this Google form to be notified of mentorship programs happening in FY24!

Program structure

| Program Title | Description |

| ---- | ----- |

| Mentor/Mentee Training | Completion of the self-paced How to be a Good Mentor or Mentee course is required of all mentors and mentees. If you prefer text-based learning or don't have a LinkedIn Learning license, you can instead review these slides. We ask that all mentors and mentees also complete the DIB training certification prior to the start of the program. |

| Initial program kickoff | Async kickoff discussion with mentors and mentees. Participation is strongly encouraged. |

| Mentorship Sessions | Mentors and mentees meet sync or async every other week for ~30-minutes for a total 5 months, (with the option to extend). Sessions are led by the mentee and should be focused on specific goals. Participation is required. |

| Mentor/Mentee Workbook | Mentorship resources are available for all mentor/mentee pairs, including suggested articles, strategies for goal setting, and sample meeting agendas. Use of resources is encouraged. |

| End of Program Celebration and Feedback | Async discussion to share mentorship success. Participation is strongly encouraged. An end of program feedback form will be shared with all mentors and mentees and is required. |

Async First Mentorship

This program includes an opt-in, async first structure to increase opportunity for team members in any time zone to pair with mentors company-wide. Async-first means that mentees can pair with mentors in any time zone. In order to be paired in an async mentorship, both mentor and mentee must opt in while applying.

Async first mentorship pairs should consider the following:

1. Connect every other week using a GitLab issue, Google doc, Slack messages or voice memos, and/or Loom recorded videos. Remember that async does not have to mean text only. See this example of async meeting formats.

1. Consider finding 1-3 times over the course of the 5-month program to meet synchronously, even if just for 15 minutes. This will require advance planning for both mentor and mentee and is not required.

1. Utilize all async resources provided on the mentorship handbook page.

Current Program Timeline

The dates for the next iteration of this program are still being determined.

Date	Description	Related Resources
TBD	Program planning	
TBD	Call for Mentors Application Opens	
TBD	Call for Mentees Application Opens	
TBD	Applications Close	
TBD	Mentorship pairing complete and communicated to applicants via Slack	
TBD	Mentor/Mentee pre-program coffee chats + async kickoff discussion and poll	
TBD	Mentorship sessions begin	
TBD	End of program async discussion + End of program feedback form shared	
TBD	Mentorship sessions end and feedback form due	

Being a Mentor

As a mentor, you benefit from:

- Fast feedback loop between team members and leadership
- Opportunity to form relationships with team members in other departments
- Opportunity to support Women at GitLab and live our values

Mentor requirements

- You have been with GitLab for at least 3 months at the time of application
- You have availability in your schedule to meet sync or async with your mentee on a bi-weekly basis for at least 30 minute meetings for the entire length of the program
- You intend to make every effort to participate in the async kickoff discussion and will complete the LinkedIn Learning or text-version of the How to be a Good Mentor or Mentee course
- You are not on a Formal Coaching plan or PIP (Performance Improvement Plan)
- You can complete the DIB training certification before the program begins

Applications will be prioritized based on:

- Skill and prior experience as a mentor
- Performance in current role
- Available and appropriate mentee match in the current session

Apply

Applications are currently closed. Fill out this Google form to be notified of mentorship programs happening in FY24!

Applying for a mentor does not guarantee you a spot in the program and eligibility will be evaluated based on criteria above and program need.

If you've participated in a previous GitLab mentor program, you are welcome to apply again!

Being a Mentee

As a mentee, you benefit from:

- Increased visibility with leadership
- Increased professional development opportunities
- Career coaching and guidance
- Opportunity to form relationships with leaders on other teams

Mentee requirements

- You have been with GitLab for at least 3 months at the time of application
- You have availability in your schedule to meet sync or async with your mentor on a bi-weekly basis for at least 30 minute meetings for the entire length of the program
- You are not on a Formal Coaching plan or PIP (Performance Improvement Plan)
- You intend to make every effort to participate in the async kickoff discussion and will complete the LinkedIn Learning or text-version of the How to be a Good Mentor or Mentee course
- You can complete the DIB training certification before the program begins

Applications will be prioritized on many points including:

- Team members on a management career track
- Performance in current role

Apply

Applications are currently closed. Fill out this Google form to be notified of mentorship programs happening in FY24!

Applying for a mentee does not guarantee you a spot in the program, and eligibility will be evaluated based on criteria above.

If you've participated in a previous GitLab mentor program, you are welcome to apply again!

FAQ

Can I participate as both a mentor and a mentee?

Yes, this is a possibility. It's important that team members talk with their managers to discuss their capacity to participate in both roles in this program. Participation in both

roles will require a 2hr commitment per month (two 30 minute sessions as a mentor and two 30 minute sessions as a mentee).

It's possible that we will have a shortage of mentors and be unable to complete all mentor/mentee pairs. If there is a shortage of mentors and you've applied as both a mentor and a mentee, you will be assigned only as a mentor in this program.

I'd like to participate but I can't commit the entire length of the program. Can I still apply?

If you cannot commit to the 5 month program, please consider applying for a future mentorship program at GitLab. It's important that both mentors and mentees are available for the full 5 month program to achieve the best results.

I'm not eligible to be a mentor or a mentee in this program. What are my options for future participation?

Team members are always encouraged to build mentor/mentee relationships independently. You can find resources and a list of available mentors in the Learning and Development handbook

Additional questions?

Questions, comments, and feedback can be posted in the mentoring slack channel. To stay up to date about future iterations of this program, please complete this interest form

Results

Metrics and Outcomes

Mentors and mentees will complete a pre-program and end of program survey to collect feedback, assess skills, and determine if goals set during mentor/mentee relationships have been set.

Success of this program will be measured by:

1. percentage of mentor/mentee pairs who meet consistently on a bi-weekly basis, with a goal of 95% completion
1. attendance to live training sessions, with a goal of 95% attendance
1. quality of feedback of the program from both the mentor and mentee perspective
1. percentage of mentee goal achieved during mentorship, as reported by mentees with a goal of at least 50% of goal achieved
1. mentor and mentee career development at GitLab after program conclusion including rates of promotion, transfer, performance growth factors, and retention

Participation

Metric	FY23 Q1/Q2		FY23 Q3/Q4 + FY24 Q1		
----		----		----	
Total Participants		86		110	
Mentor/Mentee Pairs		47		66	
Total Mentors		39		48	
Total Mentees		47		63	

| % participants who would recommend this program | 95% | 95.35% |

FY23 Q3/Q4 + FY24 Q1 Details

Participant Testimonials

1. Every time I engage in a mentorship program, I have a sense of fulfillment in coaching others but I also learn something new about myself through the engagement. I absolutely love mentorship!

1. The mentorship program was transformative for me. I plan to move towards leadership positions and I received the feedback that I need to improve my communication skills. This program helped me to uplevel my "communicating up" skill through real-life examples shared by my mentor and by discussing specific topics I faced during the programme. I feel confident now about communicating with executives and preparing documents for such discussions. I strongly recommend the program to everyone who wants to grow at GitLab.

1. Mentorship program is a great way to connect with the team members within GitLab who are expert leaders, it is always nice to have a communication with them knowing that there is no prejudice or preconceived notion. You are free to talk to your mentor, be more collaborative, make a strategy around what works best for you to grow in the field that you are in, build more interpersonal skills and develop more leadership qualities. I loved this program and I am grateful for my mentor.

1. Participating in this mentorship program was highly valuable for me. As a first year GitLab Team Member, establishing a connection with someone outside of my organization was truly helpful. At face value, the networking aspect allowed me to gain valuable insights into my team dynamic. But truthfully, the real impact was that my mentor fostered an environment of empowerment and encouragement. He provided validation and a sounding board for my concerns, as well as offered solutions whenever possible. I looked forward to our conversations every other week because I knew it was a safe space where I could be heard.

1. I was paired with a Front-end Engineer. I am not a developer, but wanted to learn the product and he encouraged me to try and resolve an issue that would require coding. He found an easy issue and coached me through resolving it. It was super informative and gave me the skills to find and potentially resolve issues in the future.

1. I've grown a lot professionally through the GitLab mentorship program. My mentor was very well chosen (I knew him already!) and was literally the perfect fit. I gained confidence, built my leadership skills and I'm taking away very valuable advice for my tenure at GitLab.

1. The program allowed me to help my mentees to set and reach clearly outlined goals related to their current roles and their future career aspirations. Personally, I gained back new insights and was able to improve on applying the GROW coaching model.

FY23 Q1/Q2 Details

Participant Feedback

What mentors and mentees learned from the program:

1. To drive change for myself and be confident - ask the questions you need to get what you want from your career.

1. The differences in communication styles and values between sales and engineering.

1. Learned more about the intersection of XDR and sales teams.

1. See every question or feedback as an opportunity to learn and grow.

1. How engineers can help non-engineers be successful in the company.
1. We don't know everything. Don't be afraid to say I don't know.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/team-workshops/_index.md

Visit the Team Workshops Level Up page to get started!

Team Workshops are customized, group learning opportunities for teams at GitLab. Workshops are interactive, collaborative, and led by expert facilitators. They are designed to address specific skill gaps, create space and time for building connection and trust, and developing shared best practices.

The program is available to all teams at GitLab, including teams of individual contributors and people leaders. Workshop duration is varied.

Currently offered workshops cover the following skills:

1. Having Difficult Conversations
1. Executive Presence and Influence
1. Storytelling
1. Building Trust and Resiliency
1. Leading through Change
1. Inclusive Leadership
1. Open and Effective Communication
1. Decision Making and Managing Ambiguity
1. Unconscious Bias

These skills were selected and prioritized based on themes derived from the talent development listening tour feedback from People Business Partners, and Elevate Programs.

To read more about each workshop, visit the Team Workshops Level Up page. Then, when you're ready to start planning, open an issue to connect with the Talent Development team for support.

SECTION: people-group/offboarding/_index.md

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Offboarding Overview

The offboarding process is facilitated by the People Connect team who collaborates throughout the process with various other stakeholders such as Team Member Relations, IT Operations and Payroll.

If you have any questions around the offboarding process, please be sure to review the Offboarding FAQs handbook page.

Note: Departing team members will receive a comprehensive email prior to their final date of

employment with information such as the impact on benefits coverage, final pay, arranging for a laptop wipe and stock administration.

Offboarding Support

For system access questions and laptop wipes related to offboarding, send an email to gitlab-laptop-recovery@gitlab.com.

For payroll questions or outstanding expense claims, please reach out to either uspayroll@gitlab.com or nonuspayroll@gitlab.com.

For any other offboarding questions from active team members please reach out to People Connect via HelpLab or send an email to people-connect@gitlab.com if your access has already been terminated.

Note: If a termination date changes, please reach out to People Connect via HelpLab. The team will update Workday. The notice is used as supporting documentation of the change and is saved in the team members Workday record. If the team member is employed via a PEO, they will also be notified by People Connect.

Voluntary Terminations

Prior to Resignation

1. Team Member: Please reach out to your Direct Manager prior to submitting your resignation particularly to discuss the handover process and the communication plan regarding your departure.
1. Team Member: Review the documented notice period for your location if applicable and factor in the notice period when submitting your resignation through Workday.
1. Team Member: Compile your Letter of Resignation for uploading into Workday. If you are employed through a PEO or Third-Party Employer, send a copy of your resignation letter to the PEO contact as well.

Resignation

1. Team Member: Following the guidelines in the 'How to Submit a Resignation' Job Aid submit your resignation directly in Workday accessible through Okta.
1. Team Member: If you are employed via a PEO or Third-Party Employer forward a copy of your Letter of Resignation directly to them.
1. Team Member: After your resignation is submitted in Workday, your manager will receive a request to complete your offboarding in Workday. Once your termination is complete, you can anticipate receiving your offboarding packet with information regarding your final pay, continued benefit offerings, and additional offboarding information such as returning your devices. You can also expect a request to complete an exit survey along with an invitation to take part in an optional exit interview within 48 hours.
1. Team Member: You should review the Offboarding FAQ handbook page to address any questions you may have. If you have a question that is not on that page, please reach out to the People Connect Team using HelpLab. Note: You will not see your offboarding issue prior to your departure as this is an issue used to deprovision access and is created once you are done working.

Country Specific Requirements for Resignation

France

In addition to submitting their resignation directly in Workday (following the guidelines in the 'How to Submit a Resignation' e-Learning or Job Aid) and complying with any contractual requirements, Team Members resigning in France should also email a copy of their resignation letter to legal-employment@gitlab.com.

Germany

In addition to submitting their resignation directly in Workday (following the guidelines in the 'How to Submit a Resignation' e-Learning or Job Aid), Team Members resigning in Germany are required to provide a wet-ink signed resignation letter to the GmbH address and should liaise with the People Connect team during offboarding to ensure it's properly provided.

Japan

Team Members located in Japan who are resigning need to complete this resignation form and send it to payroll via HelpLab by the 10th of the month in order to process this with the local provider/partner for correct taxations. Please download or make a copy of the document in order to complete.

Singapore

Team Members located in Singapore who are resigning and are not Singapore citizens need to complete a Letter of Undertaking document and send it to payroll via HelpLab in order to process this with the local provider/partner. Please download or make a copy of the document in order to complete.

UAE

Team members the the PEO/EOR on UAE work visa's who resign, completes their contract, or changes jobs, their visa must be cancelled by the company regardless of whether they leave the UAE. Team member's with dependents must first either cancel dependent visas (if dependents are leaving the UAE) or place them on hold (if dependents are staying) - this is managed by the team member as the dependent visa sponsor. The PEO/EOR company handles the mandatory work visa cancellation process through MOHRE (for labor card) and GDRFA (for residence visa), which takes 1-3 working days. Team members have 30 days after cancellation to leave the UAE or obtain a new visa. Failure to cancel properly may result in re-entry bans, overstaying fines, and complications with final payroll and health insurance processing.

Termination

1. Manager: If your team member completes a resignation in Workday, you will receive a prompt in your Workday inbox to terminate the team member by following the steps documented in the following job aid. If a resignation was not submitted, you should initiate the termination by going to the departing team member's Workday Profile and selecting Actions followed by Job Change and finally Terminate Employee).

- Note: Submitting the termination in Workday does not immediately terminate access. The

offboarding issue, which is opened on the team members last day worked, initiates the deprovisioning process for terminated team members.

1. Manager: You will be prompted to indicate whether the termination is regrettable or non-regrettable:

- Regrettable: The team members departure has a significant negative impact on the company, its customers, its projects or the team - the team member was a good and consistent performer both in terms of results and behaviours specifically upholding the GitLab values.

- Non-Regrettable i.e. The team members departure has a minimal impact on the company, its customers, its projects or the team - the team member has not been meeting expectations due to conduct, culture or values misalignment or performance concerns.

1. Manager: Once the details about the team members departure have been finalized schedule time with the team member to plan the departure announcement. Please reach out to your PBP if you need additional guidance.

1. People Business Partner: You will receive a prompt in your Workday inbox to review the termination details submitted by the Manager and to close the position in Workday. If you are aligned with the details including the final date of employment click Approve. In the instance that you feel further discussion is required a sync with the Manager and/or Team Member should be arranged and the termination can be sent back for further review.

1. People Connect: Once the transaction has been fully approved the team will receive a notification of the termination within the Workday Inbox.

Offboarding

1. People Connect: On the Last Day of Work as indicated in the Workday Termination Report at the pre-determined time the offboarding issue will be created - this will signal to all system owners that team member access can be revoked. In the instance that the automation does not trigger the offboarding can be initiated manually once this has happened all other back-end offboarding processes facilitated by People Connect can get underway.

1. Deprovisioners (Systems): You will be tagged in the departing team members offboarding issue and required to indicate that the team members access has been revoked kindly note that access to SOX Systems must be attended to with urgency and all other tasks within the offboarding issue must be closed out within five days.

Involuntary Terminations

Note: Involuntary terminations are only facilitated by Team Member Relations (TMR) who will initiate the process in Workday.

Involuntary offboarding of any team member is never easy. We've created guidelines and information to make this process as humane as we can. Beyond the points outlined below, make sure to refer to our guidelines on underperformance, as well as the offboarding issue.

Involuntary Process

The manager and the team member should have walked through the guidelines on underperformance before reaching this point.

1. Manager: Reach out to the their TMR specialist for assistance.

- TMR will ask about what the performance issues have been, how they have been attempted to be addressed, and review all manager/team member documentation.

- Once the review has been completed and the decision has been made to offboard the team

member, the manager should review the best timing for the involuntary offboarding call and termination date. We recommend to avoid scheduling a involuntary offboarding call while a team member is scheduled for any sensitive customer meetings or is on-call, per guidance below under Last working day.

- TMR will enter and approve the offboarding in Workday. Once entered, the relevant offboarding stakeholders will receive an alert via Workday reports or a Workday notification.

- TMR will work with IT in a separate Slack channel.

1. TMR: TMR will create a private Slack channel that will include the PBP, Manager, and Leader of the organization to review the offboarding and agreed upon offboarding date.

1. TMR: If applicable, TMR will prepare the severance agreement in preparation for the call between the TMR specialist, Manager, and team member. Additional guidelines for the preparation of this agreement can be found below in the Separation and Release of Claims Agreements section. To determine whether or not a severance agreement is applicable, please refer to the Severance Eligibility guidelines accessible by PBPs, and Team Member Relations Specialist.

1. Manager: Once the date and time is confirmed, the manager will schedule time with the team member and send the TMR specialist a private and separate calendar invite with the Zoom details for the meeting with the team member to share the news of the offboarding.

1. Payroll: If the team member is employed by a PEO/entity with statutory leave requirements, review if any time off needs to be paid on the last paycheck by looking in Workday in the Time Off section.

1. Payroll: If the team member has a contract with a co-employer, the payroll lead will forward an email to the contact at the co-employer with the information surrounding the departing team members statutory leave etc.

1. TMR/Manager: Discuss best mode of communicating the bad news to the team member. This discussion can happen via a private chat-channel, but it is best to be done via video.

1. TMR/Manager: Decide who will handle which part of the conversation, and if desired, practice it.

- If needed the TMR will provide the manager with a script for the offboarding meeting.

1. TMR/Manager: If the team member who is being terminated is a people manager, a communication plan for the team regarding the departure should be in place before the offboarding proceeds.

The communication plan should include: identification of an interim leader, (ideally) a scheduled meeting with the interim leader for the direct reports, a scheduled team call to announce the current manager's departure and the interim leadership, and finally an announcement in the team-member-updates Slack channel to share with the wider team.

- Important:

- Informing the team and answering questions should be the top priority.

- No announcement should be made in the team-member-updates Slack channel until the team call has been completed.

- In most cases, a team call can occur the same day of the offboarding. If necessary, the offboarding can be announced in the team-member-updates Slack channel the following day.

1. TMR/Manager: Decide what offboarding actions need to be taken before the call (e.g. revoke admin permissions), or during the call (e.g. revoke Slack and Gmail access), and which ones can wait until later. You can reference the offboarding issue template for the full list of actions. This conversation should take place in the private Slack channel with PBP, Manager and Leader.

1. TMR: If the team member is a risk to the production environment, the TMR should privately reach out to the Infrastructure Managers to determine who will be available to assist with the offboarding. Once an infrastructure team member has been identified, they should be added to the private calendar invite sent to People Connect, Security, and Payroll to hold the time for the team member offboarding. Once the offboarding conversation starts the TMR will privately

Slack the infrastructure contact the name of the team member to start the offboarding process.

Facilitating the Call

1. Manager: Deliver the bad news up-front, do not beat around the bush and prolong the inevitable pain for everyone involved. The Manager will make it clear that the decision is final, but will also explain what led to this decision and will point to the process that was followed to reach this decision. A sample leading sentence can be "Thanks for joining the call, [team member name]. Unfortunately, the reason I wanted to speak with you is because we have decided that we have to let you go and end your employment / contract with GitLab because of xyz."

1. Manager: Hand the call over to the TMR to continue.

1. TMR: The TMR will also make it clear that the decision is final, but also will genuinely listen to the team member's side of the story since there may be useful lessons in what they say for the rest of the team e.g. regarding hiring and vetting practices.

1. TMR: Make sure to communicate the practical points from the offboarding memo outlined below.

1. TMR: Once the conversation is complete, the TMR will stage the involuntary offboarding email document along with the severance document in DocuSign for review and signatures.

Critical Points During Offboarding Call {offboarding-points}

All Team Members

1. Final Pay: "Your final check (or invoice period) is for the pay period of X and includes X days of pay".

1. Company Property: "Please return all property as explained in the handbook, also please delete GitLab's email connection from your phone".

1. Business Expenses: "Please create your final expense report to Navan Expense (for employees), OR, please file any outstanding expenses with your final invoice (for contractors), so these can be reimbursed to you in a timely manner".

1. Confidentiality and Non-Disclosure: "We know you are a professional, please keep in mind the agreement you signed when you were hired".

1. Personal Particulars: If you would like GitLab to share your personal email with the rest of the company, please send an email to People Ops or a farewell message that can be forwarded on your behalf.

US Team Members

1. COBRA: "Your benefits will cease on last day of the month you are eligible for Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act ("COBRA"), the carrier (Lumity) has been notified and the carrier will send out the paperwork to your home address on file".

1. PPACA: "You may also be eligible under the Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act ("PPACA") for subsidized health care options via the marketplace.

If you are interested it is important that you sign up with the market place well before the 15th of the month to have coverage for the following month".

1. HIPAA: " Under the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA), if you need a certificate of credible coverage please download it from your current carrier's online portal or request it from People Ops".

1. Unemployment Insurance: "It is up to your state's labor agency (in CA: EDD) to decide if you are eligible for unemployment insurance".

1. Keep GitLab Informed: "If you move I want to be sure your W-2 gets to you at the end of the year.

You may also contact X at GitLab (provide phone number and email address) with any other questions that you may have" (consider inviting them to contact you at anytime for any reason).

Initiating an Involuntary Termination in Workday

1. TMR: Terminate the team member in the system by following the steps documented in the following job aid alternatively you can do so from within the team members Workday Profile by selecting Actions followed by Job Change and finally Terminate Employee.

1. TMR: You will be prompted to indicate whether the termination is regrettable or non-regrettable and whether the team member would be eligible for re-hire in future or not i.e. with review unless specifically relating to conduct or job abandonment in which case they would not be eligible.

1. People Business Partner: You will receive a prompt in your Workday Inbox to review the termination particulars submitted by the Manager if you are satisfied with the details enclosed and aligned with the Manager on the final date of employment click Approve. In the instance that you feel further discussion is required a sync with the Manager and TMR in question should be arranged and the particulars can be sent back for further review.

1. People Connect: Once the transaction has been fully approved the team will receive a TODO of the termination within your Workday Inbox.

Last Working Day

After the involuntary offboarding call has taken place and the last working day has been determined, team members will have no access to GitLab systems and may not be required to do any work on GitLab's behalf.

If they are on "Garden Leave" they will still be active on payroll through the termination date. When determining the timing of the involuntary offboarding call and termination date it is important to consider any effect this might have on ongoing tasks and responsibilities of the team member. No expenses may be incurred while on garden leave unless necessary to the performance of GitLab duties and approved by the team member's manager or as subject to local law.

As a manager, in collaboration with the Team Member Relations Specialist (TMR) and/or the People Business Partner (PBP), we recommend to avoid scheduling the involuntary offboarding call while a team member is scheduled for any sensitive customer meetings or is on-call. If this is unavoidable, the manager is responsible for ensuring a transition/remediation plan.

People Engineering automations will generate the offboarding issue at the end of the team member's last working day, as per notification from the Team Member Relations Specialist (TMR) and the People Business Partner (PBP). Once the Last Working Day or Garden leave expires the team member will be officially offboarded from GitLab. Prior to the offboarding issue and the overall process for the term listed below.

Last Working Day for US Team Members

1. TMR: TMR will have a legal/CPO review of the planned offboarding.

1. TMR: TMR will inform payroll, compensation and benefits, security and the stock

administration of the date the team member will have access suspended and the official offboarding date prior to the opening of the offboarding issue.

1. TMR: TMR will work with People Connect to ensure the offboarding issue has the correct dates and that all stakeholders in Payroll, Compensation and Benefits (Total Rewards), Security and Stock Administration have been communicated to and understand the offboarding details.

Sample Offboarding Memo

If appropriate (to be determined by conversation with the manager, the Group Executive, and People Ops), use the following offboarding memo, which is provided here as an openly viewable Google Doc, but of course needs to be personalized and tailored to each individual's situation. As written, it is applicable to US-based employees only.

Separation and Release of Claims Agreements {separation-agreement}

Separation and Release of Claims Agreements do not apply for all offboardings. To review in which cases they do/do not apply, please reference the Severance Eligibility document accessible by People Connect Team and PBPs. In the case that a severance agreement is applicable, the steps below should be followed:

Severance Process for US-based Team Members

1. TMR: The TMR Partner/Specialist assigned to the particular offboarding case at hand should select the appropriate severance template. Options include: Non-California over 40, California over 40, Non-California under 40, California under 40.

1. TMR: The TMR Partner/Specialist should make a copy of the template and save it in the Copies of Individual Severance Agreements folder.

1. TMR: The TMR Partner/Specialist should fill out the document.

1. TMR: The TMR Partner/Specialist will ping the stock team in the stock option section of the document.

1. TMR: The TMR Partner/Specialist will share with the PBP and Legal for final review/approval.

1. TMR: The TMR Partner/Specialist will stage the document in DocuSign for signatures. Please note that depending on the template used, team members have a limited amount of time to sign the Separation and Release of Claims Agreement.

- When staging the document for signatures, please note:

- Remember to send the document to the team member's personal email address

- Select the assign signature order option in DocuSign to ensure the team member signs the document first

- All US (Inc.) severance agreements should be signed by Karen Iacobucci, VP, People Operations & Technology. If Karen is unavailable then Robert Allen, CPO will be responsible for signing.

- US (Federal LLC.) severance agreements need to be signed by an appropriate team member within the Federal Entity.

1. TMR: When the signed document is received, the TMR should upload it to the team member's Workday Profile in the documents tab.

1. TMR: As a final step, the TMR specialist will email the appropriate uspayroll@gitlab or nonuspayroll@gitlab and total rewards that the final severance agreement has been uploaded to the team members Workday Profile in the documents tab.

Important Notes:

- Separation pay is not paid until the ex-team member signs the document and the revocation period has passed.
- We treat team members equally and therefore do not take tenure into consideration when determining separation pay unless legally required. We know that other companies sometimes give higher separation pay to longer tenure. We think that a short tenure can be harder to explain to a next employer and with a shorter tenure you might have less stock option upside, maybe you have not even reached your vesting cliff.
- Make sure you understand the rules for over 40.
- You must use language in your exit meeting that is in no way forceful of the ex-team member to sign the agreement. Use phrasing such as "if you choose to sign"; "you have a right to have legal council review this document before you sign", etc.

Team Member Leave during an Investigation

For team members who will be placed on leave during an investigation please follow the process below:

1. TMR: Communicates with Legal, Aligned PBP regarding the decision to place a team member on leave and disable accounts during an investigation.
1. TMR: TMR will request IT and People Connect support for disabling a team members accounts.
1. TMR: TMR schedules a call with the team member and manager to inform them of the decision to place the team member on leave while an investigation occurs.
1. TMR: TMR informs the manager and PBP when the conversation is completed and accounts are disabled. During this period managers will not have access to the team members accounts.
1. TMR: TMR notifies IT that an Out Of Office message needs to be set on the account and include the message that the team member is OOO and please reach out to their manager.
1. TMR: TMR send the team member to their personal email the "Team member Suspension letter" via DocuSign. The TMR will upload this document to the team members Workday Profile in documents tab.
1. TMR: TMR once the investigation is completed the TMR will inform the aligned PBP and manager of the final decision. If the team member is to be returned to work the TMR will reach out and schedule time to meet with the team member.
1. TMR: If the team member is returning to work the TMR will notify IT and People Connect that the team member will be returning from leave and the date that accounts should be enabled.

Offboarding Compliance

The People Connect member in the relevant rotation will complete a weekly audit of all offboarding issues opened within that specific week and check that all People Connect tasks have been completed and that the label peopleops::done has been added.

All offboarding tasks by all Departments need to be completed within 5 days of the offboarding date. For systems that are more critical and time sensitive, these will be completed within the first 24 hours (example 1Password, Slack) by the relevant Departments. Information about application & system deprovisioners can be found on the Tech Stack Applications handbook page.

To ensure a successful completion of the offboarding issue, it is important that all tasks are checked off, whether the system/tool is applicable to the offboarding team member or not. Checking the box indicates one of the following:

- I have revoked team member access to this particular system/tool
- I have checked and this team member was not given access to this particular the system/tool.

GitLab Alumni Program

All voluntary exits are eligible to be added to the Slack channel gitlab-alumni, unless otherwise noted. Involuntary exits are not eligible for the alumni channel, unless otherwise noted by Team Member Relations.

The offboarding details provided by the termination transaction in Workday is how eligibility is determined and later shared with IT.

The purpose of this channel is to network and socialize with team members.

Joining the channel is voluntary and subject to GitLab's Code of Conduct.

GitLab, the company, monitors the channel and can remove people from it at their sole discretion.

The GitLab Code of Business Conduct and Ethics is enforced in the channel.

Communicating Departures

Our goals in communicating offboardings are transparency, and to provide an opportunity for team members to say goodbye. We understand that different individuals are comfortable with different levels of communication and that each offboarding situation has different situations and nuances. For this reason and out of respect for individuals, we have a couple of key guiding principles for communicating offboarding:

1. We ask that all offboardings are announced in the team-member-updates Slack channel for transparency and awareness. While we encourage all offboardings to be posted in team-member-updates, we recognize there may be select situations that we should consider a different approach for. If a team member or their manager does not want to post in team-member-updates, please discuss with your People Business Partner or Team Member Relations.
1. Team members and managers have the discretion to determine who shares the news of the team member's offboarding (I.E. team member or manager). Regardless of who shares, it is required that team members review offboarding messaging with their managers prior to sharing.

Depending on the team members' role, timing of communication may vary (e.g. direct team, key stakeholders, etc.), and managers have discretion to determine who should be informed most immediately. The typical order followed for communicating departures is:

1. Inform Direct Team

The "direct team" is typically the team member's peers within their immediate team (I.E. reporting to the same manager and/or in the same functional group, etc.) and is typically a relatively small group of people.

In most cases, team members communicate their departures to their direct team, though messaging should be cross-checked with their manager for consistency.

2. Inform Key Stakeholders

Key stakeholder communication can be done through 1:1 notifications, and/or by posting the update in team-specific channels for general awareness. Key stakeholders are individuals that departing team members work very closely with (typically in their day-to-day work) that will feel the impact of the team member's departure in their work. Managers of key stakeholders should also be looped into communication to ensure awareness.

It is essential that key stakeholders are looped in to offboardings to:

1. Communicate go forward plans
1. Ensure business continuity and transparency

Departures should be communicated with stakeholders as soon as possible, with a maximum timeframe of 2 business days after the team member's departure.

Where possible and appropriate, we also encourage managers to work with departing team members to align on transitions plans to transition as much of the departing team members' work as possible before their departure.

In most cases, managers communicate team member departures to key stakeholders.

3. Announce In team-member-updates

As explained briefly in the offboarding issue, GitLab is not always able to provide full context on why people are leaving when they do.

However as mentioned in the procedure